Conversation track 1, 3, 4

Amber and Alfie are walking home after dinner at a tiny seafood restaurant.

Amber: Right, I'm calling it. Best meal of the year.

Alfie: No argument here. **Never have I** had scallops that good.

Amber: And the service! **Not once did** we have to flag anyone down.

Alfie: Right? And **not only was** the food amazing, but the prices were fair, too.

Amber: Thirty quid a head! How did you even find this place?

Alfie: Total fluke. I ducked in to get out of the rain.

Amber: Well, **little did you know** you'd struck gold.

Alfie: Listen to us. We sound like a couple of food critics.

Amber: Speak for yourself! Next time, we're trying the crab.

Alfie: Deal. And **no way am I** sharing it.

Study Notes

Total fluke.
Hoàn toàn là may mắn thôi.
"fluke" là chuyện may mắn tình cờ, không hề tính trước; cũng hay dùng để khiêm tốn khi được khen.
Cách nói tương đương: Pure luck.

Speak for yourself!
Bạn thì có, chứ mình thì không nhé!
Câu đáp vui khi người kia nói "chúng ta" mà mình không muốn bị tính vào.
Cách nói tương đương: That's just you!

Speak Like a Native track 2

1. Never have I had scallops that good.
weak: "have I"
strong: "Never", "scallops", "good"
Đảo ngữ: dồn trọng âm vào từ phủ định đứng đầu câu. Trợ động từ "have" đọc yếu, nối với "I" thành "hơ-vai".

2. Not once did we have to flag anyone down.
strong: "Not once", "down"
change: "have to" (v → f)
linking: "flag‿anyone"
"Not once" đọc chậm và mạnh. "have to" (phải) đọc /ˈhæftə/ "háf-tơ". "flag anyone" nối thành "fla-ghe-ni-wơn".

3. And no way am I sharing it.
linking: "am‿I"
strong: "no way", "sharing"
Nói đùa nhưng dứt khoát: "no way" đọc chậm, mạnh; "am I" lướt nhanh thành "ơ-mai". Xuống giọng ở cuối câu.

• Câu đảo ngữ: nhấn từ phủ định đầu câu (NEVER, NOT ONCE, NO WAY); trợ động từ theo sau đọc nhẹ.
• "have to" mang nghĩa "phải" đọc /ˈhæftə/, "has to" đọc /ˈhæstə/.
• Giọng Anh (Amber) thường không đọc r cuối từ: year → /jɪə/; giọng Mỹ (Alfie) đọc rõ: never → /ˈnevɚ/.

Grammar Focus

Đảo ngữ sau từ phủ định: Never / Not once / No way

Từ phủ định đứng đầu câu thì trợ động từ đảo lên trước chủ ngữ, giống câu hỏi. Dùng để nhấn mạnh cảm xúc, văn nói hay dùng khi đùa.

Never have I seen such a beautiful sunset.
Not once did he say thank you.
No way am I paying for that.

Not only… but (also)… / Little did I know…

"Not only" và "Little" đứng đầu câu cũng kéo theo đảo ngữ. "Little did I / you know" = lúc đó hoàn toàn không biết, hay dùng khi kể chuyện.

Not only is it cheap, **but** it's **also** really quick.
Little did we know the storm was heading our way.

Role Play track 6

A: Right, I'm calling it. Best meal of the year.

B: No argument here. Never have I _____.

A: And the service! Not once did we have to flag anyone down.

B: Right? And not only was the food amazing, but _____, too.

A: Thirty quid a head! How did you even find this place?

B: Total fluke. I ducked in to get out of the rain.

A: Well, little did you know you'd struck gold.

B: Listen to us. We sound like a couple of food critics.

A: Speak for yourself! Next time, we're trying the crab.

B: Deal. And no way am I _____.

Substitution Drill track 7

1. Never have I had scallops that good.
   a. tasted bread like that
   b. enjoyed a meal more
   c. eaten so much

2. And not only was the food amazing, but the prices were fair, too.
   a. the view was stunning
   b. the portions were huge
   c. the music was perfect

3. And no way am I sharing it.
   a. letting you pay
   b. skipping dessert
   c. ordering anything else